

Ania's Coffee Cart

One small business. One month. 13 everyday transactions, and where each one lands on the balance sheet, income statement and cash flow statement.

Assets = Liabilities + Equity

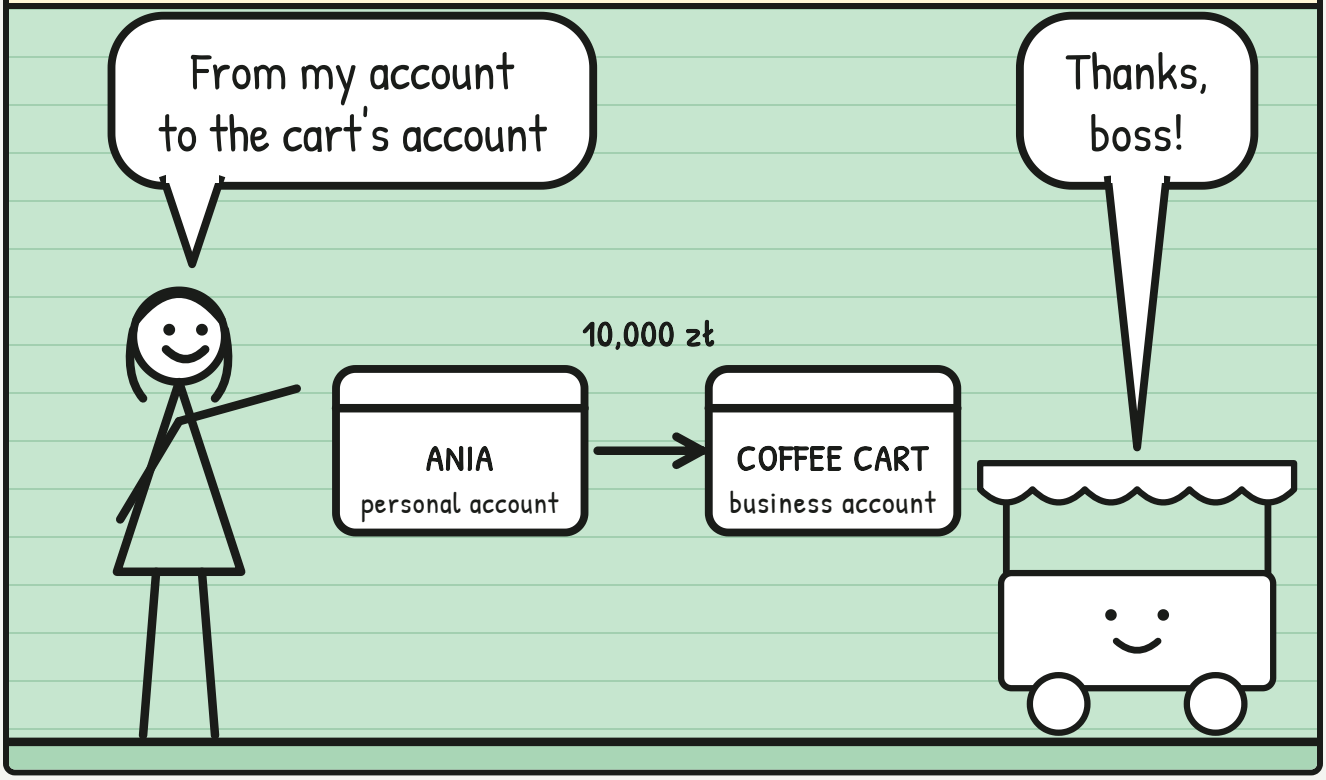
12 accounting conventions in one line each

Business entity convention	The business and the owner are separate. Keep their money apart.
Money measurement	Only things you can measure in money go in the books.
Reporting period	Chop the life of a business into months or years so you can report on each one.
Going concern convention	Assume the business will keep running and has no plan to sell off its assets.
Historic cost convention	Record things at what you actually paid.
Dual aspect convention	Every transaction has two sides, so A = L + E always balances.
Accruals convention	Profit is revenue earned minus expenses used up, not cash in minus cash out.
Revenue recognition	Count revenue when you have earned it by delivering the goods or service.
Matching convention	Put expenses in the same period as the revenue they helped earn.
Prudence convention	When unsure, don't overstate what you have or what you earned. Record losses early, gains only when sure.
Materiality convention	Small amounts that would not change anyone's decision can be handled the simple way.
Consistency convention	Once you pick a method, keep using it, so periods can be compared.

Opening the business account

PRINCIPLE: BUSINESS ENTITY CONVENTION

Day 1. Ania moves 10,000 zł of her own savings into a new bank account opened just for the cart.



WHAT THE ACCOUNTANT WRITES

Dr	Cash	10,000
Cr	Owner's capital	10,000

WATCH OUT

Ania's groceries are not cart expenses. Mixing personal and business money breaks this rule.

WHERE IT LANDS

BALANCE SHEET

Cash +10,000 · Owner's capital +10,000

INCOME STATEMENT

no change

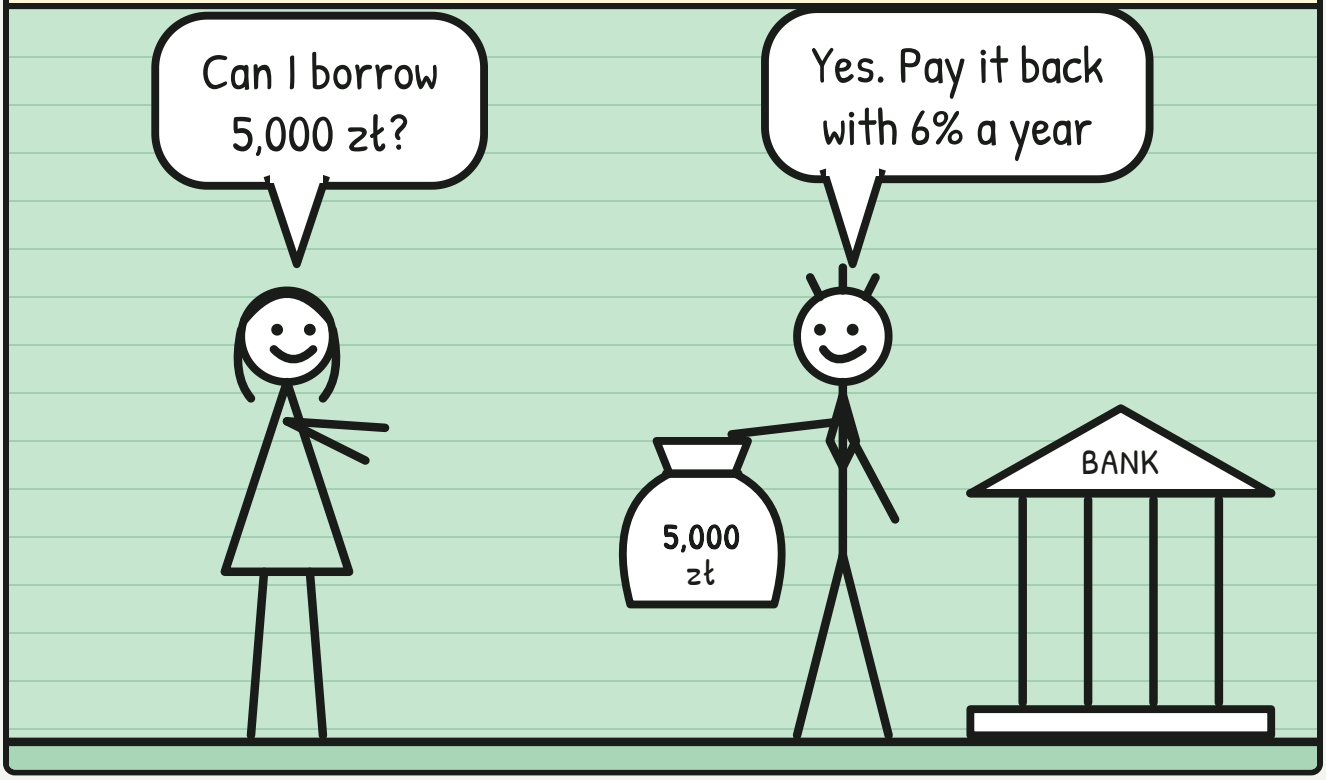
CASH FLOW

Financing +10,000

Borrowing from the bank

PRINCIPLE: DUAL ASPECT CONVENTION

Day 2. Savings won't be enough, so Ania borrows 5,000 zł from the bank at 6% interest a year.



WHAT THE ACCOUNTANT WRITES

Dr Cash	5,000
Cr Bank loan	5,000

WATCH OUT

A loan is not income. Borrowed money must be paid back, so it is a liability, never revenue.

WHERE IT LANDS

BALANCE SHEET

Cash +5,000 · Bank loan +5,000

INCOME STATEMENT

no change

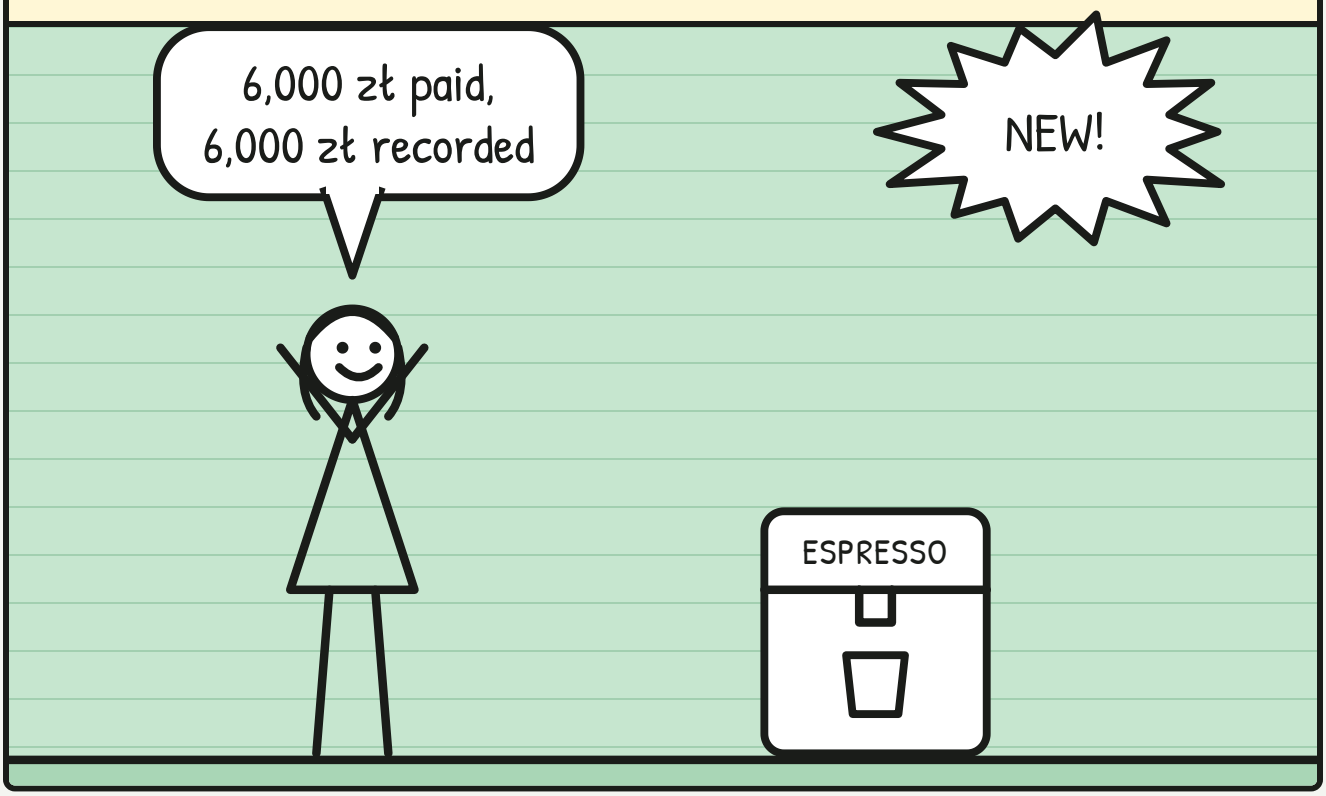
CASH FLOW

Financing +5,000

Buying the espresso machine

PRINCIPLE: HISTORIC COST CONVENTION

Day 3. Ania finds a good second-hand espresso machine and pays 6,000 zł from the cart's account.



WHAT THE ACCOUNTANT WRITES

Dr	Equipment	6,000
Cr	Cash	6,000

WATCH OUT

Don't record it at what you think it's worth ("it's a bargain, really 8,000"). Record what you paid.

WHERE IT LANDS

BALANCE SHEET

Cash −6,000 · Equipment (PPE) +6,000

INCOME STATEMENT

no change

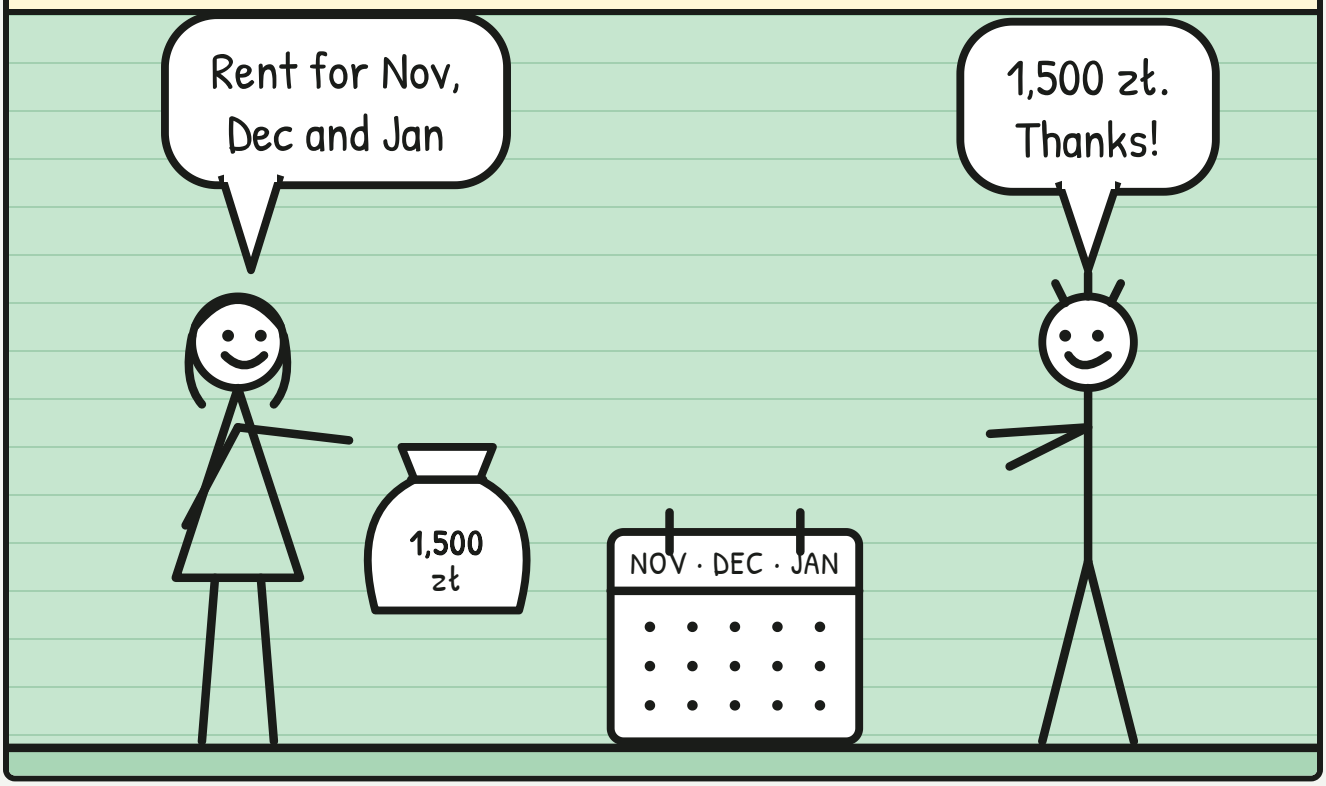
CASH FLOW

Investing −6,000

Paying rent three months ahead

PRINCIPLE: ACCRUALS CONVENTION

Day 4. The landlord wants rent for November, December and January up front: 1,500 zł in total.



WHAT THE ACCOUNTANT WRITES

Dr	Prepaid rent	1,500
Cr	Cash	1,500

WATCH OUT

Booking all 1,500 zł as November rent would make November look worse and January look better than they really are.

WHERE IT LANDS

BALANCE SHEET

Cash −1,500 · Prepaid rent +1,500

INCOME STATEMENT

no change

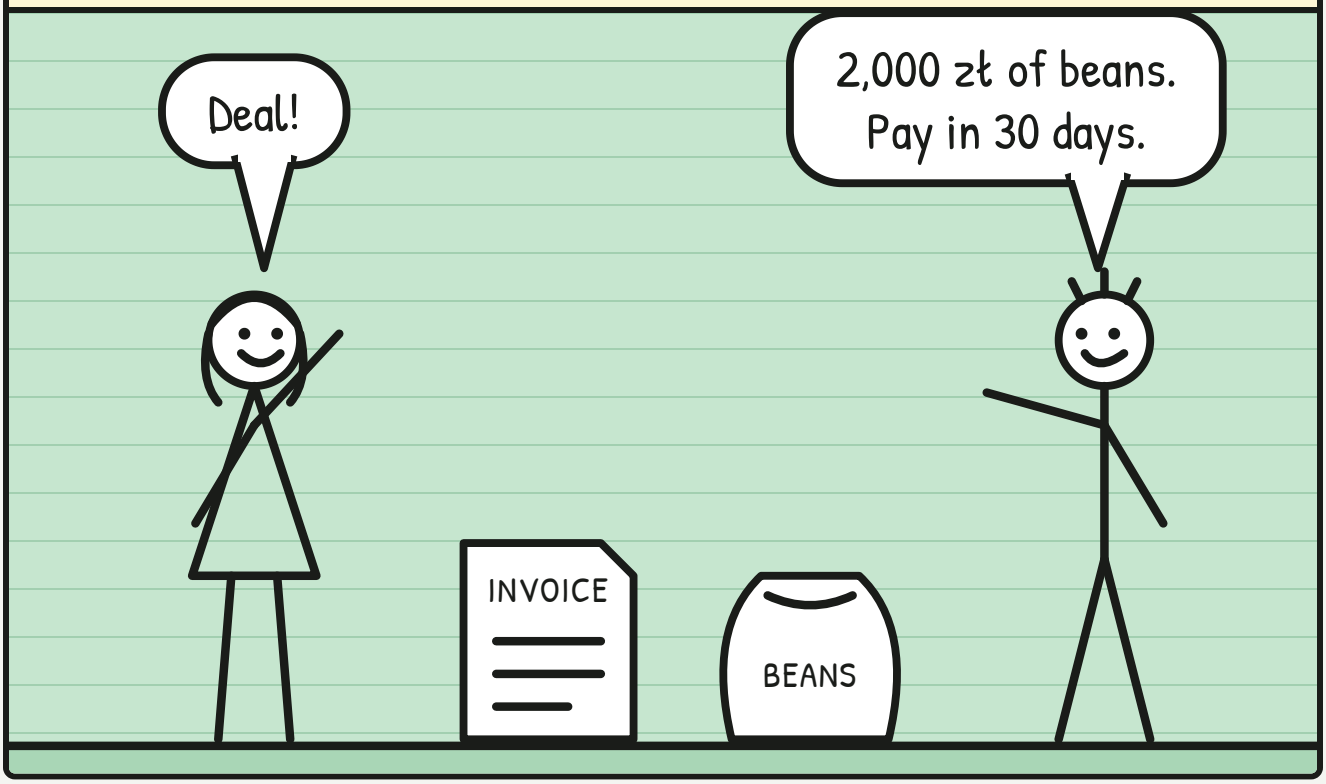
CASH FLOW

Operating −1,500

Buying beans on credit

PRINCIPLE: DUAL ASPECT CONVENTION

Day 5. A roaster delivers 2,000 zł of coffee beans. Ania can pay within 30 days.



WHAT THE ACCOUNTANT WRITES

Dr	Inventory	2,000
Cr	Trade payables	2,000

WATCH OUT

Beans on the shelf are not an expense yet. They become one only when they are used to make coffee that is sold.

WHERE IT LANDS

BALANCE SHEET

Inventory +2,000 · Trade payables +2,000

INCOME STATEMENT

no change

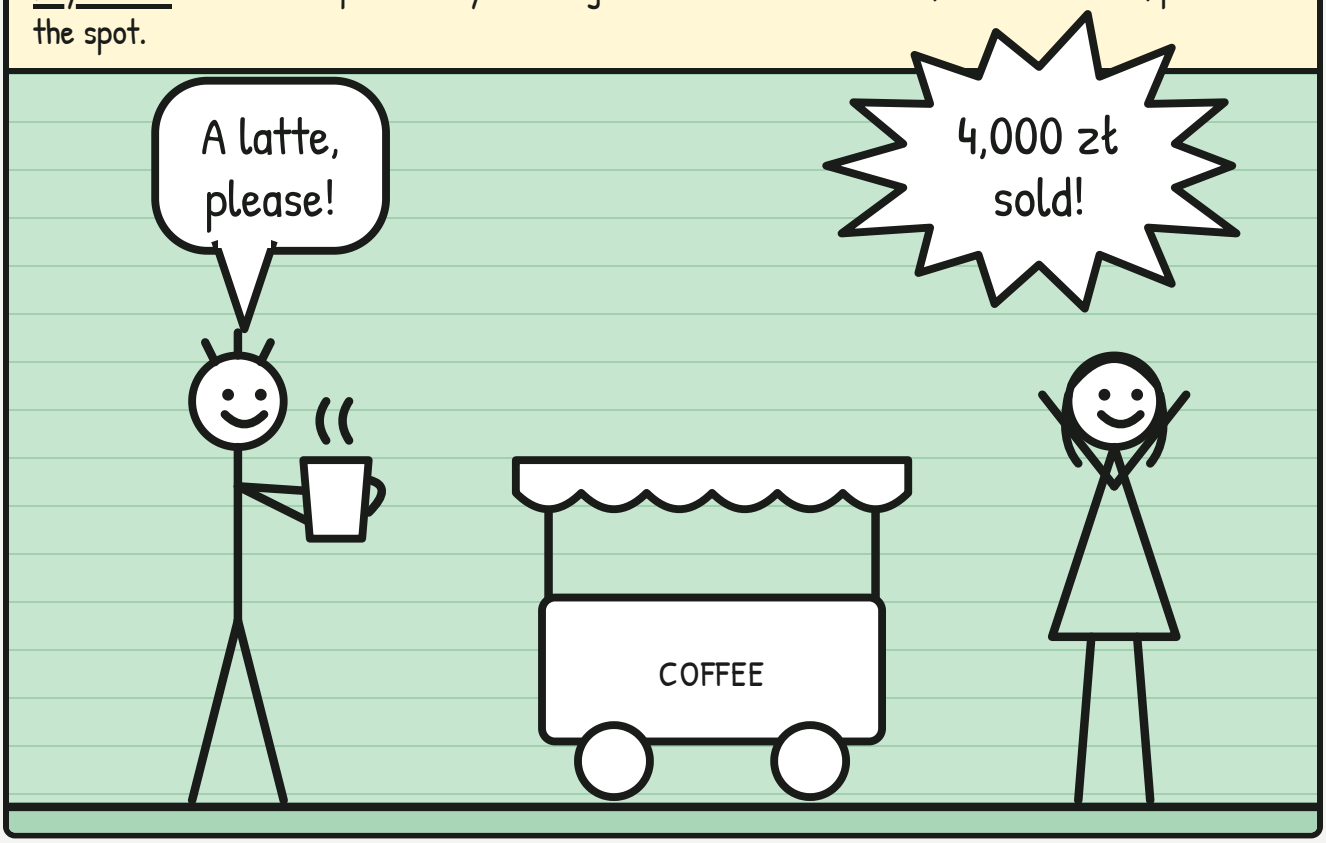
CASH FLOW

no cash moved

Selling coffee for cash

PRINCIPLE: REVENUE RECOGNITION + MATCHING CONVENTION

Days 6–30. Customers queue every morning. In November Ania sells 4,000 zł of coffee, paid on the spot.



WHAT THE ACCOUNTANT WRITES

Dr	Cash	4,000
Cr	Revenue	4,000
Dr	Cost of sales	1,200
Cr	Inventory	1,200

WATCH OUT

Forgetting the beans' cost would show 4,000 zł profit. Revenue and the costs that produced it belong together.

WHERE IT LANDS

BALANCE SHEET

Cash +4,000 · Inventory −1,200 · Retained earnings +2,800

INCOME STATEMENT

Revenue +4,000 · Cost of sales −1,200 → profit +2,800

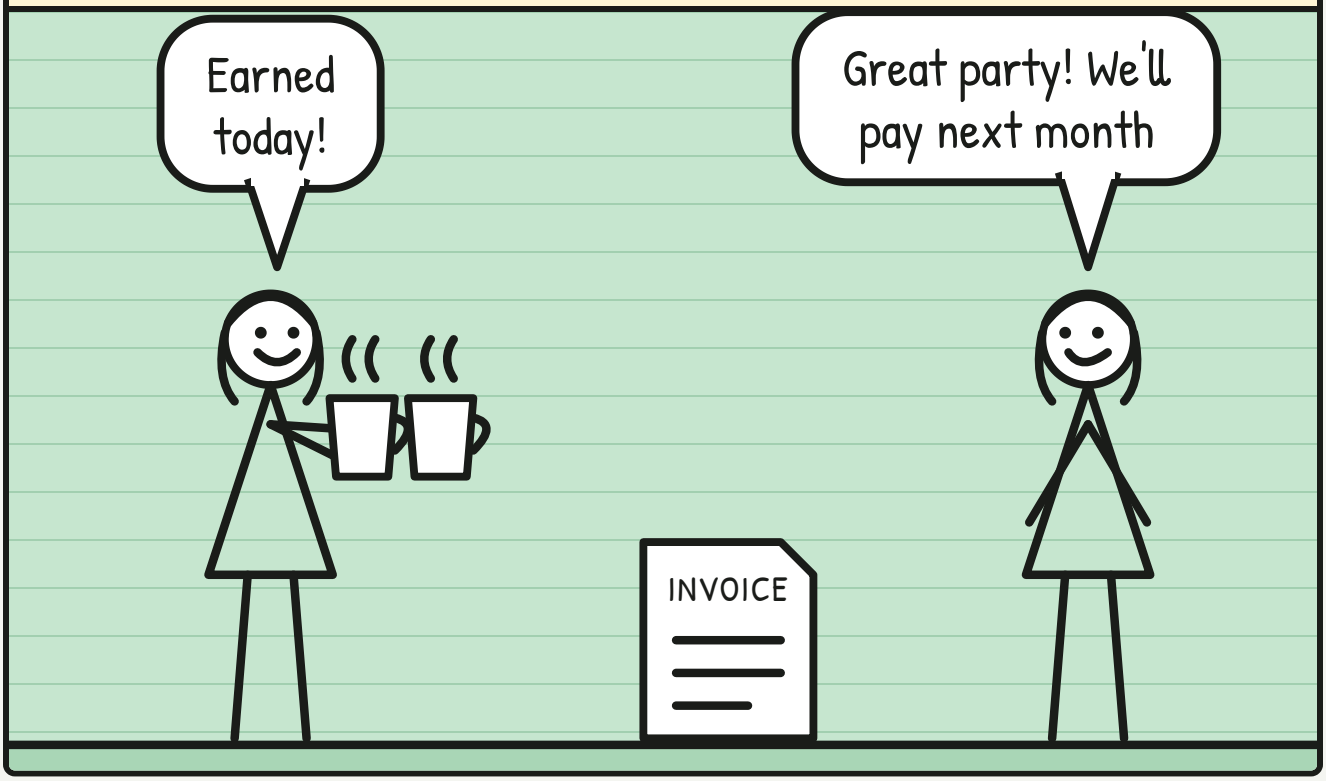
CASH FLOW

Operating +4,000

Catering an office party on credit

PRINCIPLE: REVENUE RECOGNITION

Day 20. A nearby office orders coffee for a party: 1,000 zł. Ania delivers today. The office will pay next month.



WHAT THE ACCOUNTANT WRITES

Dr	Trade receivables	1,000
Cr	Revenue	1,000
Dr	Cost of sales	300
Cr	Inventory	300

WATCH OUT

Waiting for the cash before recording revenue is cash accounting. Under accrual accounting, earning is what counts.

WHERE IT LANDS

BALANCE SHEET

Trade receivables +1,000 · Inventory −300 · Retained earnings +700

INCOME STATEMENT

Revenue +1,000 · Cost of sales −300 → profit +700

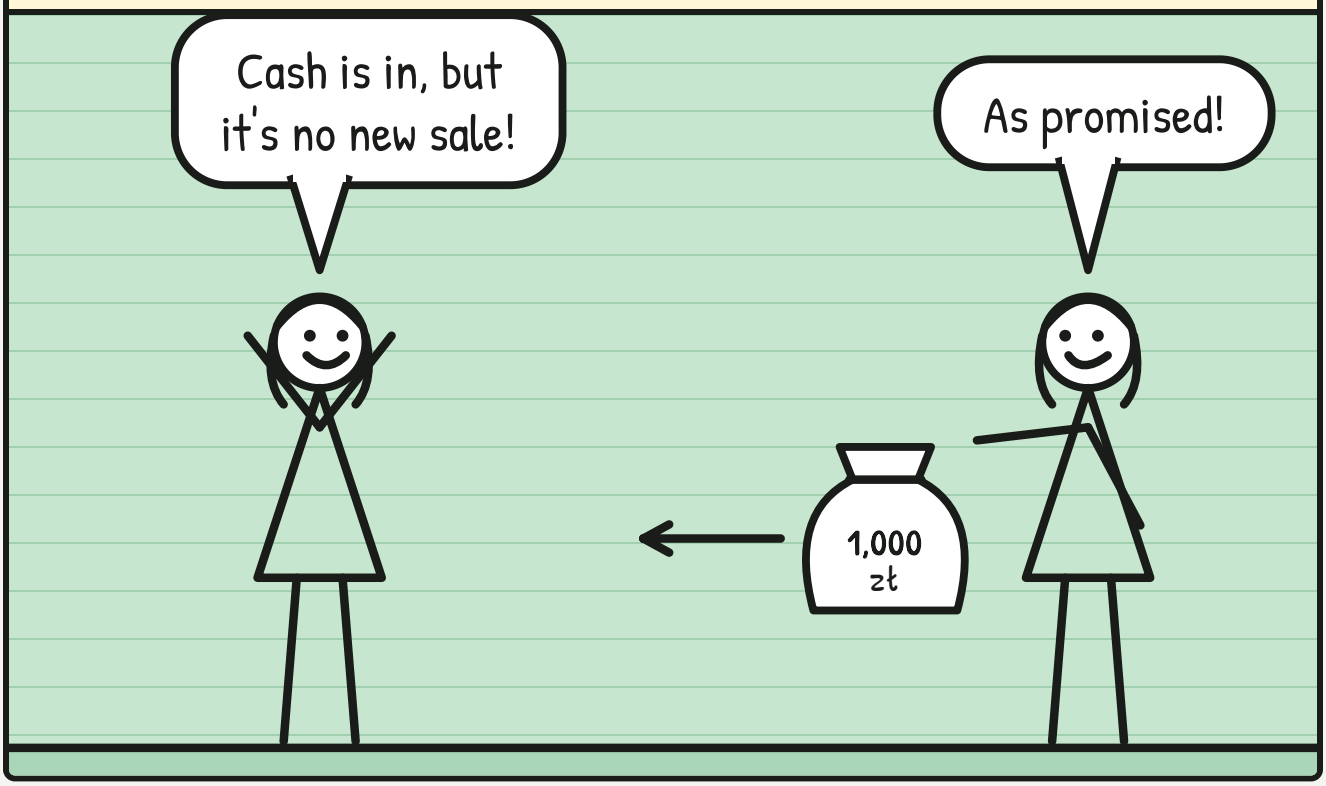
CASH FLOW

no cash moved

The office pays its bill

PRINCIPLE: REVENUE RECOGNITION

Day 28. The office pays the 1,000 zł catering bill early.



WHAT THE ACCOUNTANT WRITES

Dr	Cash	1,000
Cr	Trade receivables	1,000

WATCH OUT

Recording revenue again when the cash arrives would count the same party twice.

WHERE IT LANDS

BALANCE SHEET

Cash +1,000 · Trade receivables −1,000

INCOME STATEMENT

no change

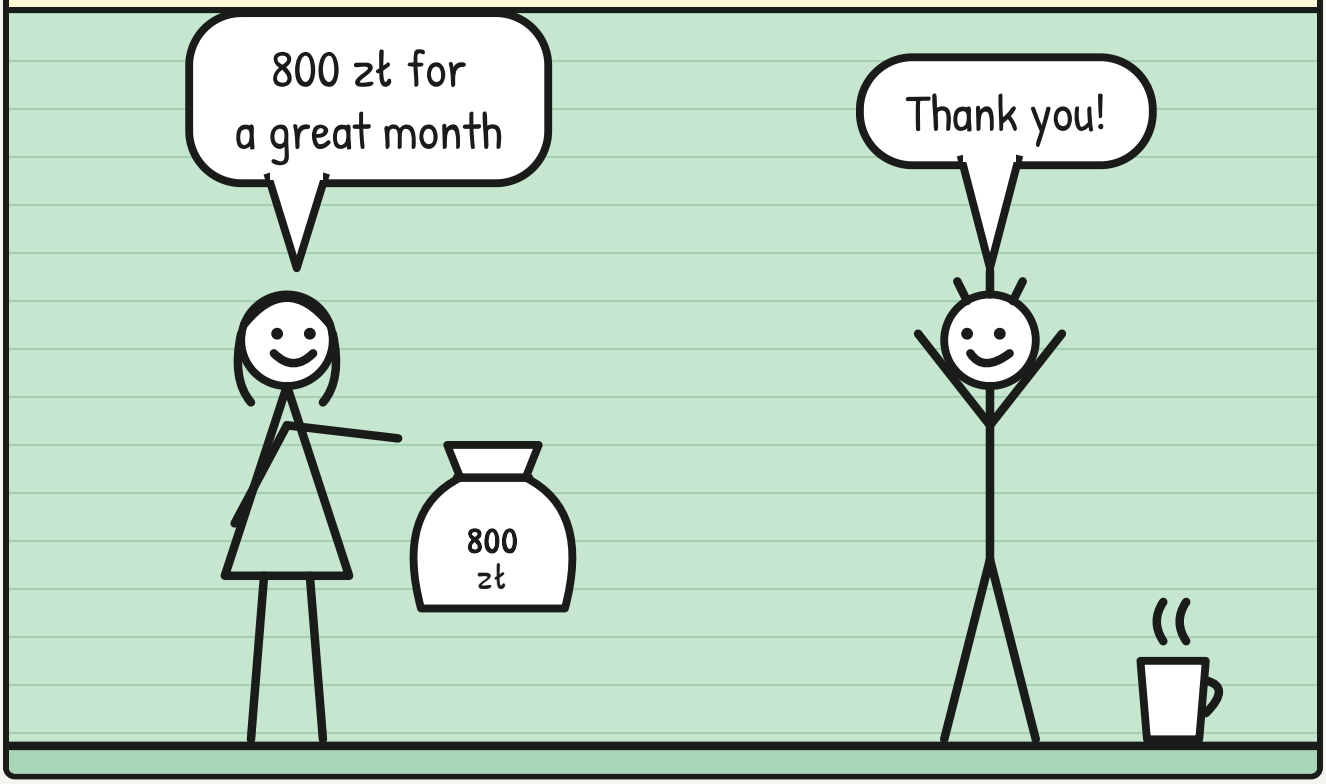
CASH FLOW

Operating +1,000

Paying the barista

PRINCIPLE: MATCHING CONVENTION

Day 30. Ania's part-time barista, Tomek, worked all month. She pays him 800 zł.



WHAT THE ACCOUNTANT WRITES

Dr	Wages expense	800
Cr	Cash	800

WATCH OUT

Paying Ania herself is different: money the owner takes out is a withdrawal of equity, not a wage expense.

WHERE IT LANDS

BALANCE SHEET

Cash −800 · Retained earnings −800

INCOME STATEMENT

Wages expense −800 → profit −800

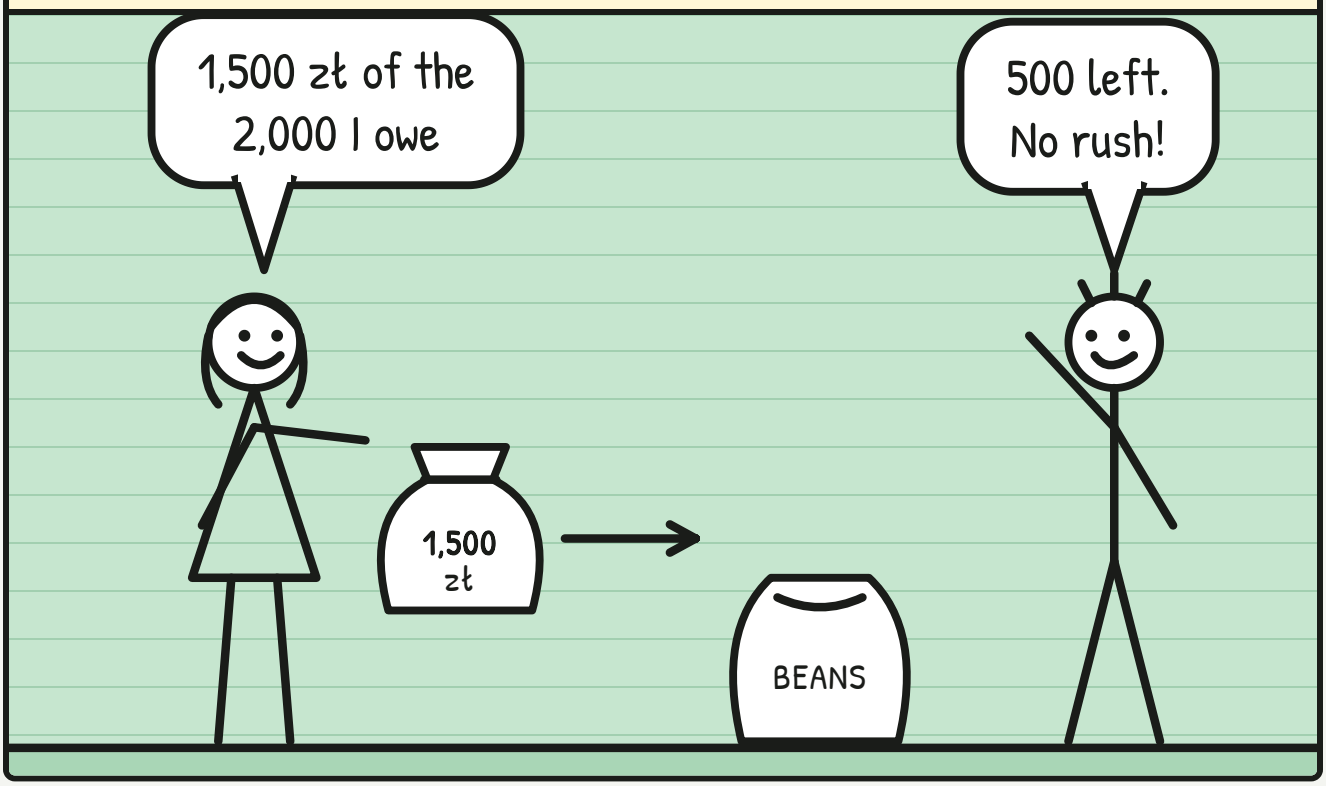
CASH FLOW

Operating −800

Paying part of the bean bill

PRINCIPLE: DUAL ASPECT CONVENTION

Day 30. Ania pays the roaster 1,500 zł of the 2,000 zł she owes. 500 zł is still to pay.



WHAT THE ACCOUNTANT WRITES

Dr	Trade payables	1,500
Cr	Cash	1,500

WATCH OUT

Paying a bill is not the same as having an expense. The expense happened when the beans were used.

WHERE IT LANDS

BALANCE SHEET

Cash −1,500 · Trade payables −1,500

INCOME STATEMENT

no change

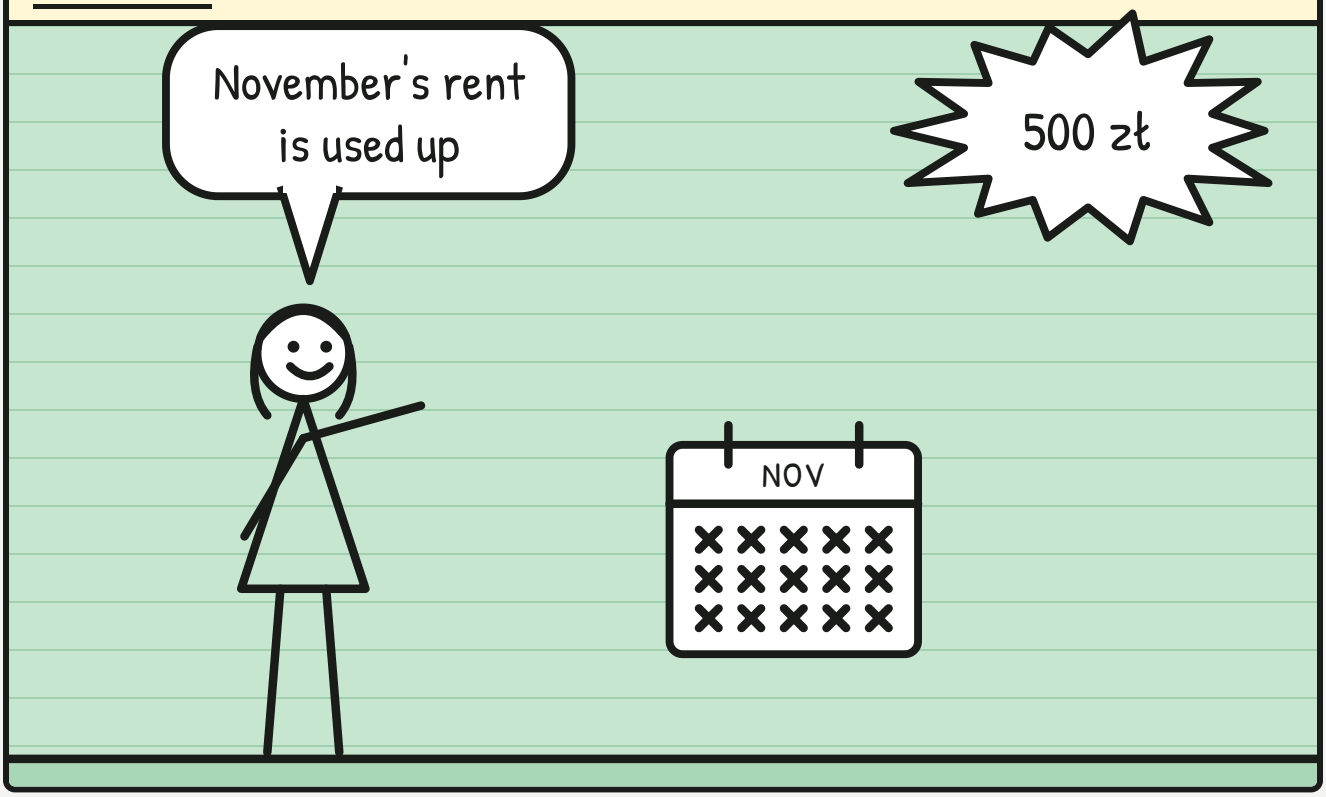
CASH FLOW

Operating −1,500

Month end: using up a month of rent

PRINCIPLE: REPORTING PERIOD (ADJUSTING ENTRY)

30 November. The month is over. Ania sits down to close the books.



WHAT THE ACCOUNTANT WRITES

Dr	Rent expense	500
Cr	Prepaid rent	500

WATCH OUT

Adjusting entries never involve cash. They fix the timing so each month shows what really belongs to it.

WHERE IT LANDS

BALANCE SHEET

Prepaid rent −500 · Retained earnings −500

INCOME STATEMENT

Rent expense −500 → profit −500

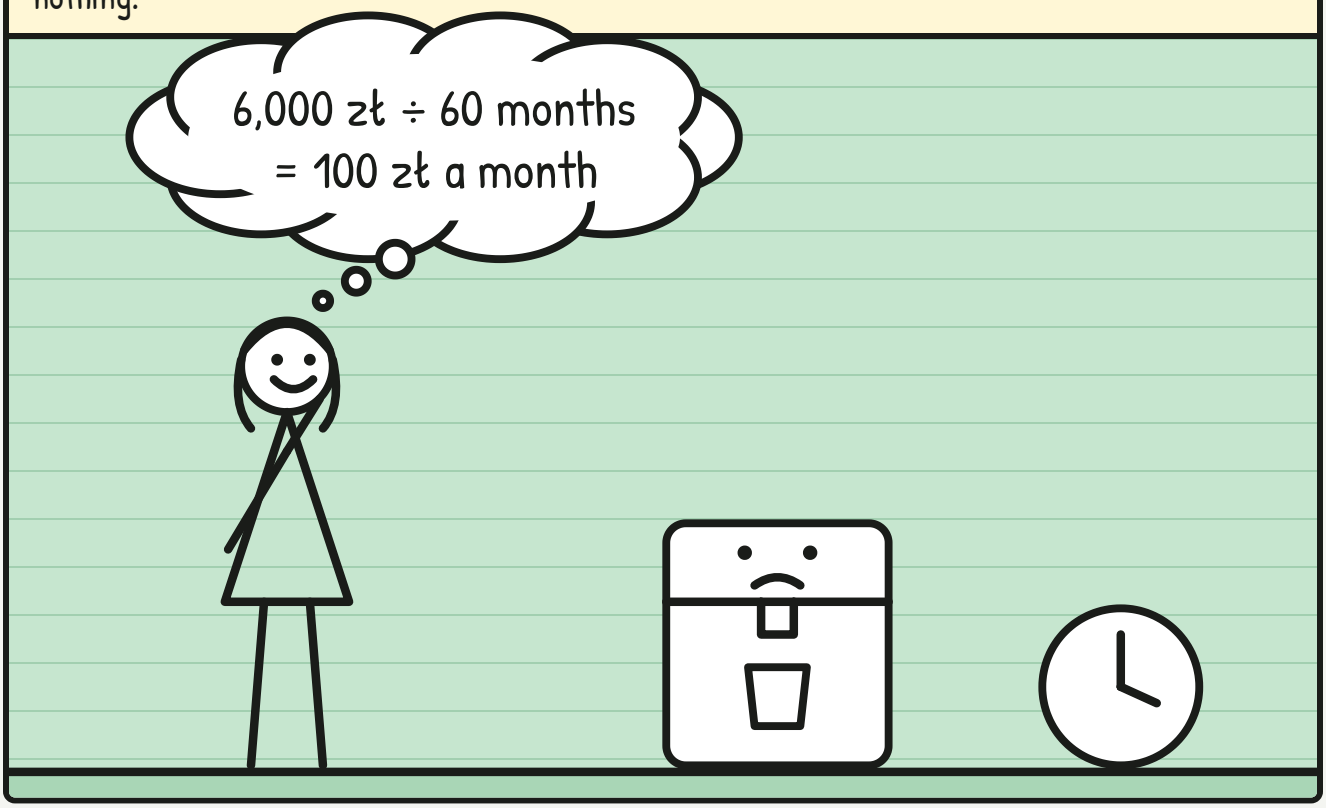
CASH FLOW

no cash moved

The machine wears out a little

PRINCIPLE: MATCHING + GOING CONCERN CONVENTIONS

30 November. The espresso machine should last about 5 years (60 months), then it will be worth nothing.



WHAT THE ACCOUNTANT WRITES

Dr	Depreciation expense	100
Cr	Accumulated depreciation	100

WATCH OUT

Depreciation uses no cash. That's why profit and cash are different numbers.

WHERE IT LANDS

BALANCE SHEET

Accumulated depreciation −100 · Retained earnings −100

INCOME STATEMENT

Depreciation expense −100 → profit −100

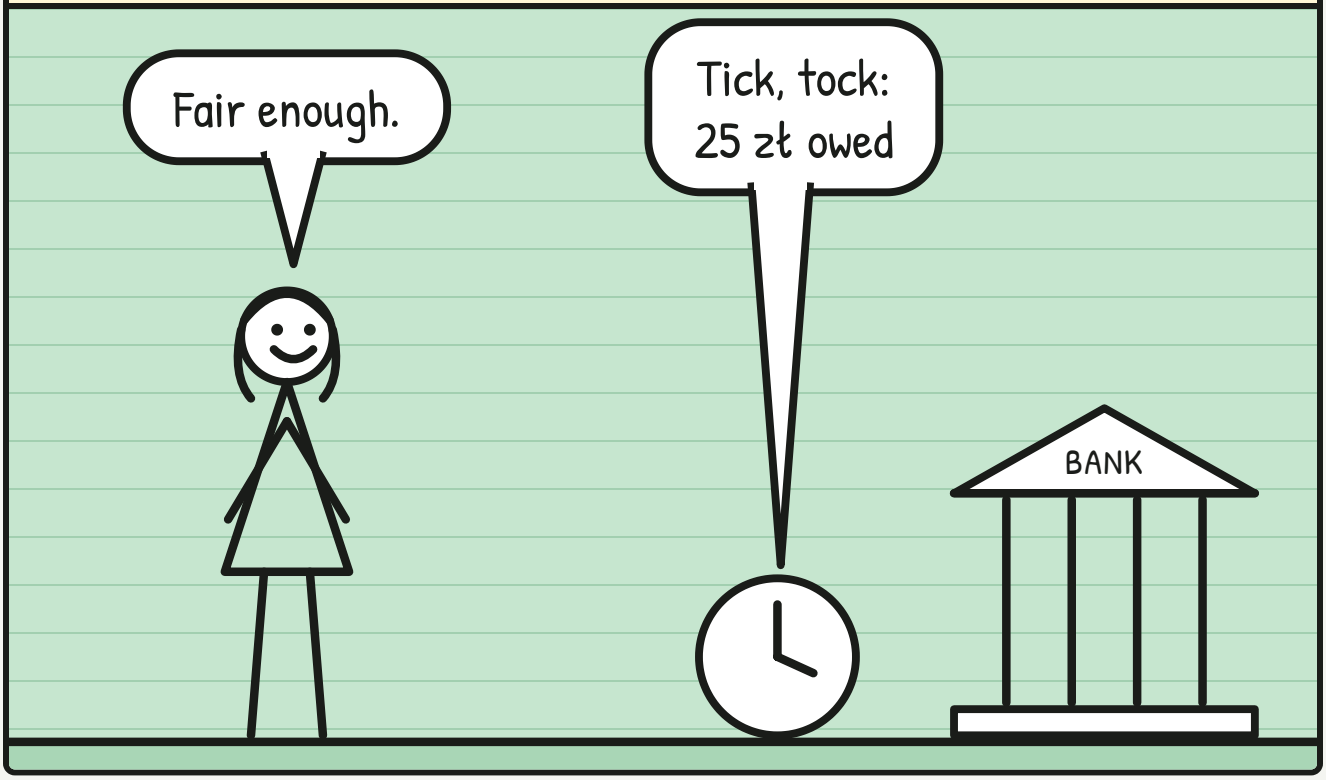
CASH FLOW

no cash moved

Interest builds up on the loan

PRINCIPLE: ACCRUALS CONVENTION

30 November. The bank only collects interest later, but every day of the loan costs a little.



WHAT THE ACCOUNTANT WRITES

Dr	Interest expense	25
Cr	Accrued interest	25

WATCH OUT

Ignoring costs until the bill arrives would make this month look more profitable than it was.

WHERE IT LANDS

BALANCE SHEET

Accrued interest +25 · Retained earnings −25

INCOME STATEMENT

Interest expense −25 → profit −25

CASH FLOW

no cash moved

After one month, everything balances

INCOME STATEMENT

November

Performance over the month

Revenue	5,000
Cost of sales	(1,500)
Gross profit	**3,500**
Rent expense	(500)
Wages expense	(800)
Depreciation	(100)
Interest expense	(25)
Profit for the period	**2,075**

STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS

November

Where real cash came from and went

Operating activities	1,200
Investing activities	(6,000)
Financing activities	15,000
Net change in cash	**10,200**

Ends at cash on the balance sheet: 10,200 zł.

STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION

30 November

The balance sheet: a snapshot on the last day

ASSETS	
Cash	10,200
Trade receivables	0
Inventory	500
Prepaid rent	1,000
Equipment (PPE)	6,000
Accumulated depreciation	(100)
Total assets	**17,600**
LIABILITIES	
Trade payables	500
Accrued interest	25
Bank loan	5,000
Total liabilities	**5,525**
EQUITY	
Owner's capital	10,000
Retained earnings	2,075
Total equity	**12,075**
Liabilities + equity	**17,600**

✓ **Balanced: 17,600 = 17,600**

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